

Bazaar



We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Geo G1

All photo, no voice

The Geo G1 has the camera and flash in the front, close to the external LCD. Its left side has the headset jack, while the right side has a camera button.

The phone stores 300 contacts, each with different numbers for home cellular and office and data such as e-mail address and anniversary.

Use the Geo G1 to take self-portrait pictures, or use the multi-shot feature to capture multiple shots at one go. A nifty feature is the inclusion of about 17 different frames that can be selected before or after clicking a picture.

The Geo G1 also includes Avatar—an application that offers you a menu of different face types, eyes, etc, that you can use to create and save digital personas. You can then associate these with your contacts, or sent them as MMSes.

Voice clarity is decent. The phone has a problem in detecting the network in weak signal strength areas and goes in search mode, thereby affecting battery life.

It captures decent images and video clips but lack of

audio support is noticeable. It connects to the PC through the serial port via the bundled cable. The Geo-sync software provided lets you synchronise data with the PC. However, it rebooted the phone a few times when we tried to connect it.

The lithium-ion battery provides about a day and a half's worth of life, though this reduces significantly if you shoot a lot of images and use the flash. An extended lithium-ion battery is also bundled that lasts for about double the time. An external desktop charger, a travel charger and a manual are also bundled.

Considering its problems with network detection, poor application support, lack of support for Java applications combined with the high price tag, this is not a worthy buy. Consider buying a Nokia 6600 in the same price range.

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions: 88 x 46 x 23.2 mm, Weight: 90 gms, dual band, dual-LCD, 260 K colours, integrated VGA camera with 4X digital zoom, video recording, MMS, 64-note polyphony

Geo G1	
Performance	■■■■■
Features	■■■■■
Ergonomics	■■■■■
Value for money	■■■■■

Price: Rs 24,999
Contact: First Mobile India Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-56944070
Fax: 022- 26845085
E-mail: response@firstmobileindia.com

ACi Ethos V Barebone G320 laptop

Affordable portable!

The Ethos V from the ACi is probably the first laptop to carry a price tag as low as Rs 30,000. Its 256 MB DDR RAM is shared by S3 graphics core.

It has a D-SUB connector to connect an external display, serial and parallel ports to connect a mouse or printer, and a PS/2 connector for a keyboard.

The keys make quite a noise; but they have a grainy finish and provide good tactile feel. There are four hotkeys provided to control volume and access the Internet and e-mail clients.

The 14.1-inch TFT screen provides enough space to work scroll free in Word or Excel applications and also view Web pages easily at a resolution of 1,024 x 768.

In Business Winstone 2002, we got a low score of 11.5, which means that this

product will provide crash-free computing only with older applications. In *Quake III*, we got a playable frame rate of

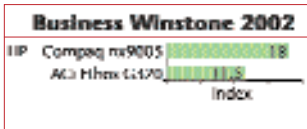
30.8 at 640 x 480 pixels. At a higher resolution of 1,024 x 768, we got just 10.2 fps. The Ethos V isn't heavy, yet it's not compact, which makes it feel hollow. It

didn't heat up after even four hours of use—good news for those who want a travel companion.

Overall, the Ethos V is suited for students and small business owners to access e-mail, keep notes and type business letters. At just Rs 30,000, this laptop is ideal for those on shoestring budgets.

SPECIFICATIONS

VIA Ethos 1GHz CPU, 256 MB DDR RAM, 20 GB hard drive, 10/100 LAN, 56K modem, 14.1-inch TFT LCD screen, Weight: 2.4 Kg



Price: Rs 30,000
Contact: Allied Computer International (Asia) Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-56943260
Fax: 022-26733119
E-mail: sales@aci-asia.com
Web site: www.aci-india.com

ACi Ethos V Barebone G320 laptop	
Performance	■■■■■
Features	■■■■■
Build Quality	■■■■■
Value for money	■■■■■